

In February 2010, I found my first job at Moviefone, later bought by the *Huffington Post*, through AOL Entertainment's job listings website. I was hired to do some short celebrity phone interviews, funny lists about old movies, and various news posts about show business. It was a far cry from the Watergate-breaking reporter I thought I'd be. I'm still not sure why they hired me.

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While I worked my day job at the *Huffington Post*, I decided to start a side project. I wanted to be a news journalist, and what I was doing wasn't going to get me there. I remember thinking one night, and I don't know what inspired the thought, but it's something I carry with me even now: "To be able to do the thing you want, you have to already be doing it." It doesn't make sense to sit at an entertainment writing job and wish you were an investigative reporter. No one is going to know that's what you really want to do or hand that to you from where you currently are. You have to show them you're already doing it, so they can hire you to do it for them.

So while I was home in Florida for a visit in 2010, I sat in my teenage bedroom and started a blog. This blog is what would eventually launch the career I have today. It was called *100 Interviews*. I decided to launch my blog on Tumblr, a new platform at the time. The goal was simple: interview 100 people in one year. I made a list of types of people I wanted to interview—"someone who survived Hurricane Katrina," "a professional skateboarder," "someone who works at NASA"—and then I committed to finding those people and writing up interviews with them on the blog. It was a massive undertaking.

The blog started out slowly; then one day it got written up in the *Village Voice*. I've searched for years for the person who did the write-up because it didn't have a byline and no one has ever come forward, even though I've promised the person a swift kiss on the mouth. (This might be why they're in hiding.)

After that little article, the blog gained followers. I'd never had followers before, and with that came eyeballs suddenly counting on me to finish the project. What had started as a little idea to keep me busy while I worked my first